

Table 1: Summary Statistics

Variable	Unit	N	Mean	SD	Min	P25	Median	P75	Max
<i>A. Independent Variables</i>									
CashScrutiny	C	76,570	0.4250	1.7576	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	100.0000
GEPU_log	C	88,205	4.6872	0.3672	3.8626	4.3797	4.7238	4.9666	5.5106
HighCashScrutiny	C	76,570	0.1127	0.3162	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000
PRisk	C	85,995	99.6187	146.5189	0.0000	17.0778	53.3729	120.1973	1192.4308
PreAnnounceQtr	C	88,205	0.0094	0.0963	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000
US_EPU_log	C	88,205	4.7123	0.3661	3.8018	4.4805	4.6891	4.9625	5.6478
<i>B. Dependent Variables</i>									
BGTLevel_Spread	C	87,018	0.0017	0.0026	0.0001	0.0004	0.0009	0.0017	0.0164
UncAnsCEO	C	71,748	0.7806	0.3925	0.0000	0.5147	0.7415	1.0018	2.5874
UncPreCEO	C	71,727	0.6602	0.3917	0.0000	0.3810	0.6001	0.8723	2.2432
UncResCEO	C	44,900	-0.0000	0.3010	-1.5108	-0.1846	-0.0180	0.1650	1.7794
<i>C. Firm Controls</i>									
Capex	C	87,627	0.0487	0.0536	0.0000	0.0176	0.0324	0.0592	0.5203
CashRatio	C	87,990	0.1708	0.1806	0.0000	0.0368	0.1047	0.2435	0.9938
CashRatio_lag	C	79,131	0.1709	0.1804	0.0000	0.0367	0.1048	0.2443	0.9938
DivDummy	C	88,134	0.4755	0.4994	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000	1.0000
EarnVol	C	87,440	0.0701	0.1907	0.0006	0.0163	0.0315	0.0695	19.5101
FirmMat	C	87,571	-0.0432	2.1826	-317.5714	-0.0078	0.2191	0.4195	0.9252
HighCash	C	87,990	0.3333	0.4714	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000	1.0000
Leverage	C	87,994	0.2330	0.2240	0.0000	0.0470	0.2065	0.3455	3.9453
NegCall	C	86,858	0.9210	0.3024	0.0000	0.7038	0.8798	1.0943	2.3901
ROA	C	87,552	0.0386	0.1330	-3.9826	0.0146	0.0525	0.0925	0.5490
TobinsQ	C	87,363	2.1363	1.5197	0.3847	1.2681	1.6791	2.4362	35.6144
UncQue	C	81,031	1.4398	0.4831	0.0000	1.1216	1.4108	1.7268	3.5945
lnAssets	C	87,994	7.4710	1.6607	-0.5692	6.3008	7.3763	8.5436	12.4592
sCFO	C	83,662	0.0619	0.2233	0.0014	0.0236	0.0395	0.0664	32.4035

Notes: Summary statistics for variables used in the hypothesis tests. Sample period: 2002–2018. Anchor sample (H1, Main): 88,205 earnings-call observations across 1,884 firms. Unit column: C = call-level, F = firm-year. N varies by row because each variable is summarized on its anchor panel's Main sample (complete cases per variable); per-suite samples differ due to lags, control availability, and merges. PRisk is hassan2020's scaled political-risk score (a weighted, capped bigram index), not a percentage.